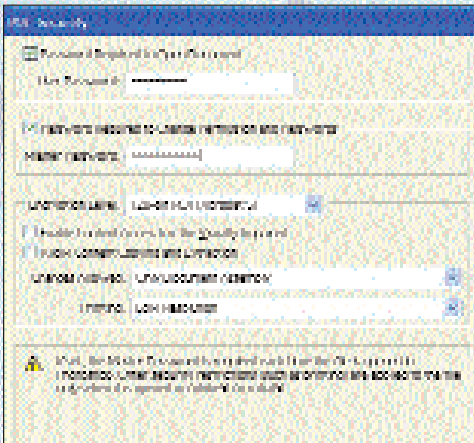


Auto Colour: This new feature completes Adobe Photoshop's set of automated colour correction tools. You can automatically remove colour casts from images as it adjusts the contrast and colour of an image with a slightly different algorithm than the 'Auto Levels' command.

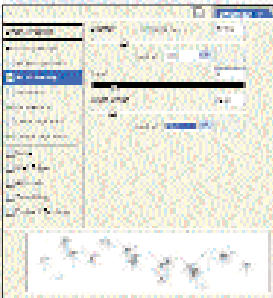
G.V. Sreekumar: A good feature for beginners, but it cannot be a substitute for the colour correction work done by professionals. Since this is based on a set of rules, the results might not be the same in all images. I tried this feature in five images, out of which three came out with better results.
Swaroop Biswas: This feature is quite helpful.

Protect and Share Images: Most designers would be sceptical about sharing images as they might be modified by the person accessing them. Considering this, Adobe has come up with a reasonably good security feature where in one can save the file in PDF format, and set a password to view it, change the content or print the image. With 128-bit encryption, it becomes very difficult to crack the password.



G.V. Sreekumar: An excellent feature. For example, in a publishing house like Digit, the digital imaging artist can share images with others involved in the production, at the same time restricting certain users from retouching any images.
Swaroop Biswas: With this feature, exchanging images is much safer now.

Newer Paint tools: With amazingly realistic dry and wet brush effects, you can simulate traditional painting techniques. Creating customised brush shapes is easier now with settings for shape, tilt, spacing, scatter, jitter, diameter, texture, etc. The preset brush styles make it a pleasure to add special effects such as adding grass or leaves.
G.V. Sreekumar: Fans of Fractal Painter will have to seriously consider having a look at this! Options like Dry Media, Special Effects, Thick Heavy and Wet Media are very useful for professional illustrators who work on Photoshop and switch to Painter for special effects.
Swaroop Biswas: Now the brush effects are much easier to generate.



Improved Features

Picture Package: The enhancements made to the 'Picture Package' feature are designed to save time and money while printing images. You can add text and labels to images and you can now print more than one image per page and output images either as one flattened document or in separate layers.
Scripting plugin: You can automate repetitive tasks and key workflows using the rich scripting support. This can be downloaded from Adobe's Web site.
Larger pane for viewing filter effects: Version 7 gives you a considerably larger viewing pane while applying filter effects.
Rename layers: You can rename a layer by simply double-clicking on the layer name in the layer palette and typing directly on screen.
Fill, Blending and Opacity: There are two separate options for increasing or decreasing the opacity and the amount of colour filled in the object. This is helpful in decreasing the opacity levels of the fill applied to an object without affecting the other parts of an object. New blending modes such as 'Vivid', 'Linear' and 'Pin light' have also been introduced in this version.

Support for newer operating systems: This version of Photoshop is fully compatible with all the newer operating systems such as Windows XP and Mac OS X.
Preset Image Sizes: The latest version of Photoshop comes with various preset sizes to create documents. Although a minor improvement, it is quite helpful.

Vector Shapes: Dealing with vector shapes in Photoshop 6 was rather confusing. In version 7, every time you draw a shape a new layer is automatically created instead of your having to add that shape to the original layer. This allows one to create layer masks using the 'Pen' tool, which is extremely useful in creating cutouts without making any change to the original image.

The bottomline

All said and done, is it worth upgrading to Photoshop 7? The addition of a few new tools and a couple of enhancements will, in all probability, not make much of a difference to your working environment if you are an amateur user. But the value of these improvements will definitely be recognised by hardcore professionals who use this software on a regular basis. These 'minor' enhancements will allow digital imaging artists to achieve greater accuracy levels while manipulating images in less time.

Parameters	Photoshop 6.01	Photoshop 7
Start up time	22 seconds	23.5 seconds
Memory consumption	23 MB	30 MB
Time taken to complete PS5 filter test	458.10 seconds	437.8 seconds

Photoshop 7	
Performance	▶▶▶▶▶ A-
Ease of Use	▶▶▶▶▶
Value for Money	▶▶▶▶▶
Features	▶▶▶▶▶
OVERALL	▶▶▶▶▶

Contact: Adobe Systems India P Ltd
Phone: 0128-4532026
Price: Rs 31,500 (upgrade Rs 7,800)
E-mail: sandeepm@adobe.com
Web site: www.adobe.com

System Requirements:
Pentium III or 4 processor; Windows 98/98 SE/Me/NT with Service Pack 6a/2000 with Service Pack 2/XP; 128 MB RAM (192 MB recommended); 280 MB free hard disk space; 800x600 colour monitor with 16-bit colour video card

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